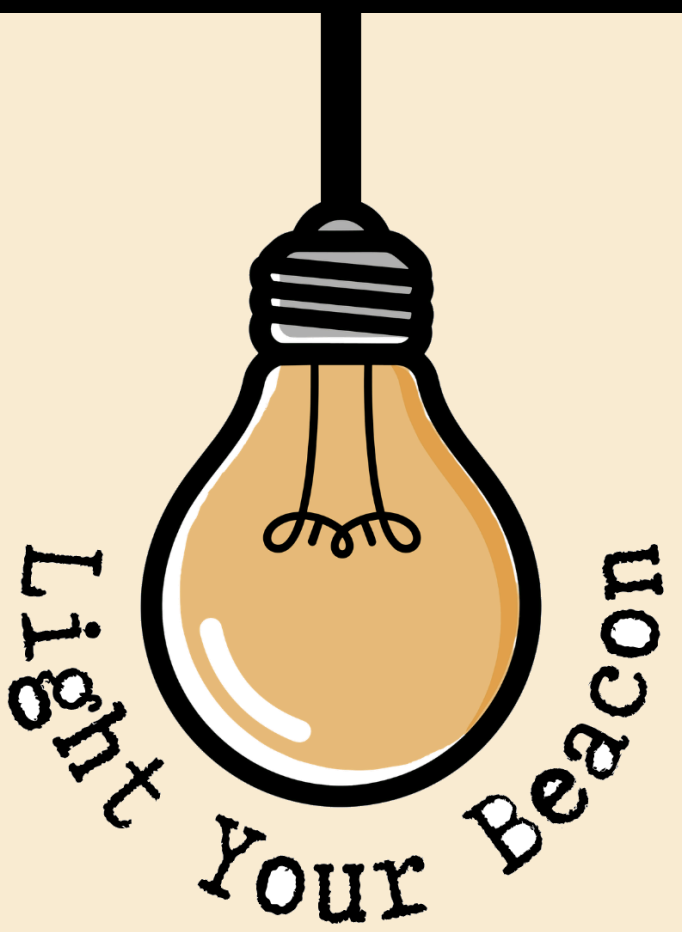


A SHORT GUIDE

How to leave social media without disappearing

One page, one goodbye, and a light that blinks once a month after you're gone.

BC Gordon

Own Your Media Club · ownyourmedia.club/offline

START HERE

What a beacon is

Deleting your accounts can feel like slipping out the back door on people who'd still want to find you. A beacon is the other way out: you leave, but you leave a light on, so anyone who comes looking knows where you went.

It's four small pieces. No automation, no posting new things, no checking in. Once you're through the door, you're gone.

1 Your beacon page

One simple page that says you've stepped away and where people can find you now.

2 Your light

A short loop: a bulb flickers on and "Light Your Beacon" appears. Use the free one or make your own.

3 The goodbye

A last bow, then the beacon post, pinned to the top of your profile.

4 The pulse

The same light, posted about once a month, so people scrolling past still see it.

WHAT IT TAKES

Time	One afternoon, plus about 20 minutes a year to refill the pulse
Cost	$0. A web address of your own is optional, about $12 a year
Tools	A free page builder and Buffer's free plan. No code

Before you start

- ☐ **Decide where people can find you.** It doesn't need to be a project. Your email, a phone number, a standing dinner or a place you go every week all count.
- ☐ **Save what you want to keep.** Most platforms have a "download your data" option in settings. Start it now; it can take a day.
- ☐ **Tell the people closest to you directly.** The beacon is for everyone else. Your favorite people deserve a text.

STEP ONE

ABOUT AN HOUR

Make your beacon page

This is the one page every old profile will point to. Keep it short, warm and easy to read on a phone.

OPTION	GOOD FOR	COST
Carrd	The easiest start. Drag-and-drop, looks good on phones, made for one-page sites.	Free at yourname.carrd.co
Google Sites	If you already use Google. Plain but dependable.	Free
A page on your own site	If you already have a website or blog. Add a page called "offline."	What you already pay
Your newsletter's About page	If you write a newsletter, this can be your beacon page.	Free

What to put on it

1. **A plain headline.** "I've left social media, but you can still find me."
2. **A short note in your own voice.** Two or three sentences on why, and that you didn't want to just disappear.
3. **Where to find you.** One to three places, each with one clear button or line: a newsletter, an email address, a club, a café, a table.
4. **One real thing to come to.** A place or a date beats "find me in the real world." Even "most Thursdays at the library" works.
5. **A note that the accounts aren't watched.** Say plainly that nobody reads messages there, and how to reach you instead.

> SEE ONE
>
> Mine is at **ownyourmedia.club/offline**. Borrow anything that helps.

STEP TWO

TEN MINUTES

Your light

The light is what people will see in their feed after you're gone: a short loop where a bulb flickers on, the words "Light Your Beacon" appear, and "See you in the real world..." types itself out.



The free light. Twelve seconds, loops forever, no name or link on it.

Use the free one

Download it from **ownyourmedia.club/offline**, free to use, no credit needed:

- **The GIF** for Threads, Bluesky, X and Facebook
- **The video (MP4)** for Instagram, which takes video but not GIFs in a post

It has no name or address on it, so it works for anyone. Your caption and link do the pointing.

Mine adds my address as a last typed line: *www.ownyourmedia.club/offline*. If you can make a version with yours, even better.

Or make your own

Anything that reads as "the light is still on" works, and something personal is even better:

- A few seconds of video of your actual porch light, a lamp in your window, or a candle on your table
- A photo of the place people can find you, with a line of text over it

Keep it short (3 to 10 seconds), quiet and readable without sound. Most phones can trim a video, and a free converter such as ezgif.com can turn it into a GIF.

STEP THREE

YOUR LAST DAY

The goodbye

First, take a bow

Make your last hand-made post a wink: the closing scene of *The Truman Show*. Truman smiles and says, "In case I don't see ya, good afternoon, good evening, and good night," bows, and walks out through the door.

Don't download the clip. Pick it from the app's own GIF search, so it's shared the way those clips are meant to be: search "Truman Show good night." Threads and Bluesky both have a GIF button when you write a post. Instagram's feed doesn't, so use the GIF sticker in a Story there, or skip the bow on that app.

Then, post the light and pin it

Right after the bow, post your light with a short caption and your link, then pin it to the top of your profile. This is the post people will find.

BEACON POST · BORROW AND CHANGE

I've stepped away from social media, but I didn't want to just disappear. I left a light on. Here's where to find me now: **[your link]**. I won't see messages here, so reach me there instead. See you in the real world.

Finally, point everything home

- ☐ **Bio:** one line that says you've stepped away, plus your link.
- ☐ **Website or link field:** your beacon page, on every account.
- ☐ **Messages:** turn on an automatic reply if the app offers one.

BIO

Stepped off social media. The real conversation is somewhere else now: **[your link]**

STEP FOUR

TWENTY MINUTES A YEAR

The pulse

A pinned post only helps people who visit your profile. The pulse puts the light back in front of everyone else: the same light, about once a month. Nothing new, nothing that pretends you're still there.

1. Make a free **Buffer** account and connect your old accounts (the free plan covers 3). Instagram needs a free Creator or Business account before Buffer can post to it.
2. Schedule your light once a month. The free plan holds 10 scheduled posts per account, so one sitting covers most of a year.
3. Rotate two or three short captions so the posts don't look like spam.
4. Put a reminder on a paper calendar ten months out: "Refill the pulse."

PULSE CAPTIONS · ROTATE THESE

Still offline. The light's still on: **[link]**
Light your beacon. Mine's still on: **[link]**
This post sent itself. I'm out here: **[link]**

STEP FIVE

Close the door

- [ ] Check that your first pulse is scheduled and your beacon post is pinned.
- [ ] Turn off every notification from the apps.
- [ ] Log out, then delete the apps from your phone.
- [ ] Leave the accounts standing. Don't delete them: the light needs somewhere to shine from.



You don't owe the feed your attention. You don't owe anyone a disappearance, either. Light your beacon, and go live the life it's pointing to.

– BL

Lit yours? Tell me where, and I'll add it to the wall of lights:
hello@ownyourmedia.club

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